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Welcome to FSX: Steam Edition.

This note explains where to find more information to enjoy your flight simulation experience. It also includes a list of frequently asked questions.

This product is a re-publication on Steam of the hugely successful Microsoft Flight Simulator Gold Edition. There are a small number of differences that delivering the game via Steam has necessitated - these are summarised below.

The following manuals are provided in the directory "<drive:>\Program files (x86)\Steam\SteamApps\Common\FSX\Manuals\English\":

FSX_Start	This "Start here" guide
FSX_QRC	Quick Reference Guide
FSX_man	Insider Information
Fsxx_Man	Acceleration Pack guide
FSX_Multi	How to use multiplayer features

There are a number of areas where these manuals do not reflect the operation of the Steam version of the product. These are listed here.

There also is a huge amount of detailed information available online. Check out www.fsxinsider.com, and <http://www.microsoft.com/Products/Games/FSInsider/product/learning/Pages/default.aspx>.

Change to Quick Reference Guide

Because Steam uses F12 for Screenshots, the **Select Views** keys used in FSX: Steam Edition are F9, F10, F11 and **Shift-F12**.

Changes to "Insider Information" manual

Page 2. The "Trouble-free Installation" and "Trouble-free Activation" sections should be ignored. Steam will install FSX: Steam Edition onto your machine without manual intervention. You will be asked to agree to the terms and conditions controlling use of the software.

If you use the User Access Control ("UAC") features of Windows Vista and above, unless you are logged on as an administrator, you may be prompted to permit multiple program changes during installation. This is normal and can be avoided by temporarily disabling UAC via the Control Panel.

Installation will normally create an FSX icon on your desktop.

Page 18. FSInsider.com is replaced by FSXInsider.com where information specific to the FSX: Steam Edition is hosted. All references to FSInsider.com should be replaced by FSXInsider.com



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Changes to "Acceleration Pack" guide

Page 2. The Installation section should be ignored. Steam will install FSX: Steam Edition on your machine without manual intervention. Installation will normally create an FSX icon on your desktop.

Page 18. FSInsider.com is replaced by FSXInsider.com where information specific to the FSX: Steam Edition is hosted.

Page 21. GameSpy is not included with FSX: Gold Edition. Multiplayer features are provided using Steam features. All references to FSInsider.com should be replaced by FSXInsider.com

Additional Information

1. Connection to the Internet

FSX: Steam Edition requires you to be logged on to Steam during loading. If you subsequently lose your connection to Steam, you will be able to continue to play, unless you are using multiplayer features.

2. Steam Offline mode

FSX: Steam Edition can not currently be used in Steam's offline mode, you must be online when starting the game.

3. Reinstalling FSX: Steam Edition

There is a huge range of add-on content available for FSX and some add-ons can cause unexpected unwanted side effects. If your version of FSX Steam does not operate correctly, Steam provides the ability to reinstall the product to the default system. To perform this reinstallation, you should perform the following steps:

1. Sign off Steam
2. Backup the disk containing you FSX installation
3. Delete the contents of the "<drive:>\Program files (x86)\Steam\SteamApps\Common\FSX\" and all subdirectories
4. Log on to Steam
5. Select "View Games Library" from the "Games" menu
6. Right-click the FSX: Steam Edition icon and select "Properties"
7. Select the "Local Files" tab and click on "Verify Integrity of Games Cache"



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FAQs -TECHNICAL

What is the minimum specification?

OS: Windows XP, Vista, 7, 8, 8.1 (Mac OS *not* supported)
Processor: 2.0 Ghz or higher (single core)
Disk: 12 GB or more free
RAM: 1 GB RAM
Other: DirectX 9 hardware compatible, audio card with speakers or headphones
Video Card: DirectX 9 compliant video card or greater. 128 MB video RAM or higher. Shader Model 1.1. or higher

Is DirectX 10 or 11 supported?

FSX: Steam Edition will work on DirectX10 and 11 although only modest support for DirectX 10 is included.

Does FSX: Steam support 64 bit operating systems?

During testing we have ensured that FSX: Steam runs on 64-bit operating systems, but the software is a 32-bit application.

Which operating system will FSX: Steam fully support without having issues?

We have tested FSX: Steam Edition on Windows XP, Windows Vista, Windows 7 and Windows 8.1 - both 32 bit and 64 bit (please note that FSX is only a 32 bit app) and can confirm running the software under these operating systems. However, due to the fact that operating systems and hardware can be configured in multiple ways we cannot guarantee that every configuration will work immediately, but it is our intention to ensure that as many people as possible are able to use FSX: Steam Edition without problems.

Will I be able to continue using my hardware (eg. Yokes, switch panels etc) with FSX: Steam?

Nothing in the simulator has been changed to interfere with the use of flight peripherals however due to the numerous different ways hardware can be implemented it is possible there may be issues in some set-ups.

FAQs - Add-ons

Will my existing collection of non-Steam add-ons work with FSX: Steam Edition?

There are so many add-ons currently available for FSX that we cannot promise that all of them will work with no issues. FSX: Steam Edition is installed in a different way to the boxed version and occupies a different location so it is possible that some add-ons may not work, but rest assured that we have made every effort to ensure that as many of them as possible work. Where add-ons do not immediately function with FSX: Steam Edition we will try to work with the community, developer or publisher of the add-on to find the solutions as needed. Again, we cannot promise that 100% of all add-ons released over the history of FSX will work with FSX: Steam, but we are committed to trying.

Will I be able to continue using freeware add-ons with FSX: Steam?

As with all other existing add-ons available for FSX we cannot give any guarantees that these will work without issue, however nothing has been intentionally changed with the simulator to block the use of free add-ons.



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If I have both versions of FSX on my system, in which version of FSX will the non-Steam add-ons be automatically installed?

Most add-ons supplied include installers that are outside of our control and so we cannot definitively predict what their behaviour will be. We expect that most would default to whichever version of FSX was installed first. With some add-on installers, you may be able to direct the add-on installer to deploy into FSX: Steam Edition, but we cannot guarantee the add-on will function correctly in this environment.

Will there be any conflicts if FSX: Box and FSX: Steam Editions are installed on the same computer?

We have worked very hard to make sure the two can coexist, but we cannot guarantee that in all circumstances there will be no problems. If you have a very extensive add-on collection, you might want to consider installing them on separate machines.

FAQs - Multiplayer

Will the Steam edition be compatible with the boxed version for multiplayer users who use LAN?

Not at this stage. Our aim is to ensure that users of FSX: Steam can connect to other Steam users.

Will there be support for existing FSX community initiatives such as VATSIM and IVAO?

It is our hope that virtual airlines and other FSX community developments continue to flourish and will do everything we can to ensure that is the case. At present we do not believe there will be any issues affecting these services, but as ever at present we cannot give a 100% guarantee.